

KIDS BIBLE CLASS · JULY — WEEK 1

The Story of the Farmer

Matthew 13:1-23

*"The good soil stands for the people who hear God's word
and let it grow."*

based on Matthew 13:23 (NIV)

When we listen to God's word and let it grow in us, it grows into something wonderful.



Image 1

One day Jesus sat by a lake, and so many people came to listen that He told them a story.

"A farmer went out to plant seeds in his field," Jesus said.

The farmer reached into his bag and scattered the seeds all around as he walked. The seeds landed in all different places.



Image 2

Some of the seeds fell on the hard path where everyone walked.

The ground was too hard, so the seeds just sat right on top.

Then the birds swooped down and ate them all up! Those seeds never had a chance to grow.



Image 3

Other seeds fell on rocky ground where there was only a little bit of dirt.

They sprang up fast! But the roots couldn't grow down deep through the rocks.

When the hot sun came out, the little plants dried up and wilted away, because they had no strong roots.



Image 4

Other seeds fell among the thorns and weeds.

The seeds started to grow, but the prickly weeds grew up faster and bigger all around them.

The weeds crowded the little plants so much that there was no room left for them to grow.



Image 5

But some of the seeds fell on good, soft soil.

Those seeds grew down deep, became strong and healthy, and made a harvest bigger than anyone imagined!

Jesus said our hearts can be like that good soil. When we really listen to God and let His word grow, it grows into something wonderful.

WHAT WE LEARN

Jesus said the seeds are like God's word, and our hearts are like the soil. Some people hear about God but quickly forget, or let other things crowd it out. But when we really listen, remember, and let God's word sink in deep, it grows into something good and beautiful in our lives — just like the seeds in the good soil.

For you: You can be the good soil! Listen carefully to God's word, think about it, and let it grow in your heart a little more every day.